

of all projects, respective deadlines, delivery dates, invoices and other reminders. Project management tools enable a team leader to keep track of everything on one platform.

Such tools allow team leaders to create and assign tasks, deadlines, track unassigned tasks and so on with one tool. Customisable dashboards enable them to create an intuitive and understandable interface for efficient task management. They can also set up a workflow to get validations at different levels and automate emails to concerned teams.

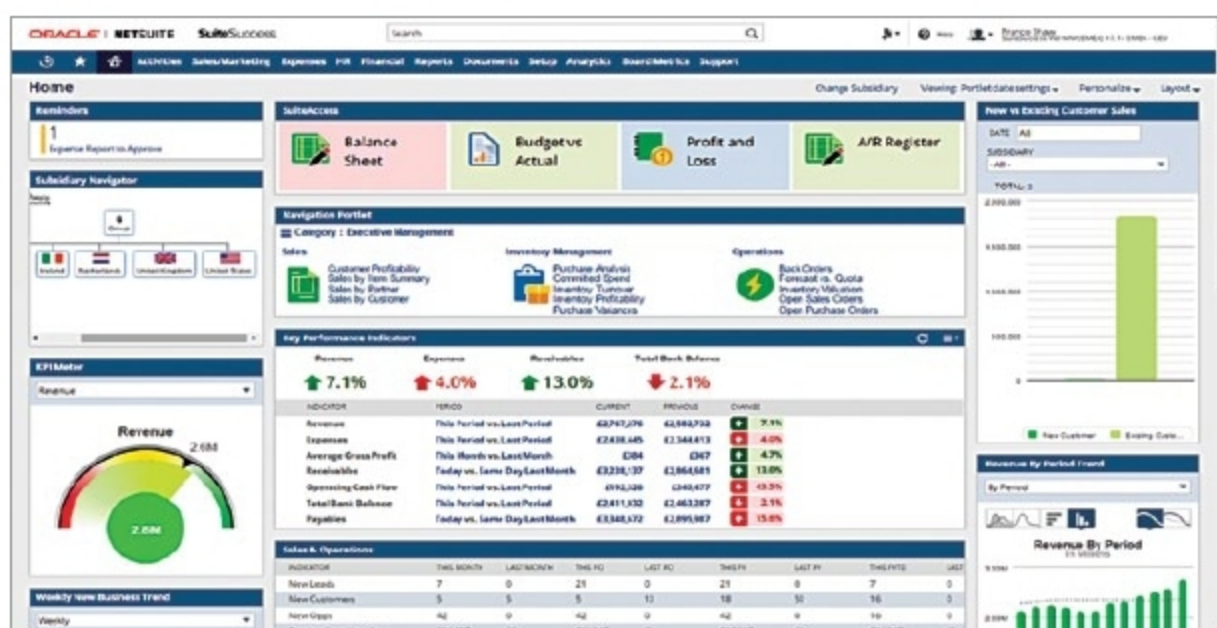
For HCL Technologies, Zoho Projects has proved to be the most efficient cloud-based project and bug tracking tool for them. The company has benefited from its availability on cloud, which enables project managers to access it even while travelling, for keeping track on resources and project timelines. HCL has even recommended the tool for project tracking to some of their clients.

Scoro is another project management tool. Aesara Partners, a UK-based consultancy, claims to have saved 30 per cent time on managing work. It moved from Excel to Scoro, replacing many manual processes. Quality control of service more than doubled, which resulted in increased efficiency and profitability. The firm saved 100 per cent time in accessing live reports by utilising real-time dashboards.

Survey and review tools

Survey tools. Organisations can create a set of questions and send it to their targeted audience to collect feedback or analyse the market scope of a product or service. There are various free and paid tools available in the market, using which they can analyse their net promoter score (NPS) and market reputation by sending a survey to existing and potential clients. They can upload a mailing list, design a survey website, add questions, send the survey and report on responses.

Brazil's Tam Airlines used Survey Monkey to improve employee satisfaction. It regularly surveyed employees whose job was to simply enter the responses to various surveys and found that they had problems with speed, accuracy and reporting. Survey Monkey replaced the slow and tedious



Netsuite ERP tool

paper survey and automated the process of interviewing experiences, training subjects, town hall meetings and exit surveys.

Review tools. These are similar to survey tools with one additional feature. Reviews are automatically sent to search engines such as Google or Bing, and can be searched by potential customers. These tools help in building trust with customers.

Staysure.co.uk, a UK-based travel insurance company, has established long-lasting relationships with its three million policyholders in the last ten years. The trust it has established with its customers is reflected with over 30,000 five-star reviews from Trustpilot (a review tool)—this is more than any other travel insurance provider. Its team now pulls data-driven reports from Trustpilot's tool to identify the most common customer complaints and prioritise new solutions.

CRM tools

Business growth requires customer retention and a proactive approach towards potential customers. This can be accomplished using customer relationship management (CRM) tools. Such tools can help businesses identify potential sales opportunities and increase customer retention. CRM tools also enable users to create customers' query tickets, set up tasks for follow-ups and improve accountability in employees as all actions can be audited.

Salesforce is one such solution for large organisations. However, small- and medium-sized organisations do not need a solution with these many

features. For that reason, there are other affordable solutions.

360 Payments, a Silicon Valley company, uses Pipedrive CRM tool and has successfully scaled its net income by 298 per cent, new accounts by 26 per cent and gross revenue by 40 per cent. The company has achieved such impressive results with fewer employees. To expand the business in other locations and track sales individually from each location, it was able to achieve it with Pipedrive Platinum.

Smartpress Chanhassen, USA, uses Cooper CRM and has reduced its contact creation time by 90 per cent. Smartpress also claims that before Cooper, the company was losing 25 per cent of its leads because of delays in follow-ups. Now, tasks are automatically assigned and conversion rate has significantly improved.

ERP tools

If an organisation has multiple departments and all are using different tools, then there is a need for ERP tools. Such tools can be integrated with various other tools and display data on one platform. Users can monitor finances, resources, sales and inventory within one tool.

ERP tools ensure that data from all tools gets updated on a single platform. These integrate core business processes to streamline communication, business transactions, effective database management and strengthen customer relations. Such solutions are highly-customisable and can be implemented in any workflow.

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